Solution

(a) The potential energy $U = mgh$ = $2 \times 10 \times 5 = 100$ J

Here the positive sign implies that the energy is stored on the mass.

(b) This potential energy is transferred from external agency which applies the force on the mass.

(c) The external applied force $\vec{F}_a$ which takes the object to the height 5 m is $\vec{F}_a = -\vec{F}_g$

$$\vec{F}_a = -\left(-mg\hat{j}\right) = mg\hat{j}$$

where, $\hat{j}$ represents unit vector along vertical upward direction.

(d) From the definition of potential energy, the object must be moved at constant velocity. So the net force acting on the object is zero.

$$\vec{F}_g + \vec{F}_a = 0$$

4.2.6 Elastic Potential Energy

When a spring is elongated, it develops a restoring force. *The potential energy possessed by a spring due to a deforming force which stretches or compresses the spring is termed as elastic potential energy*. The work done by the applied force against the restoring force of the spring is stored as the elastic potential energy in the spring.

Consider a spring-mass system. Let us assume a mass, m lying on a smooth horizontal table as shown in Figure 4.9. Here, $x = 0$ is the equilibrium position. One end of the spring is attached to a rigid wall and the other end to the mass.

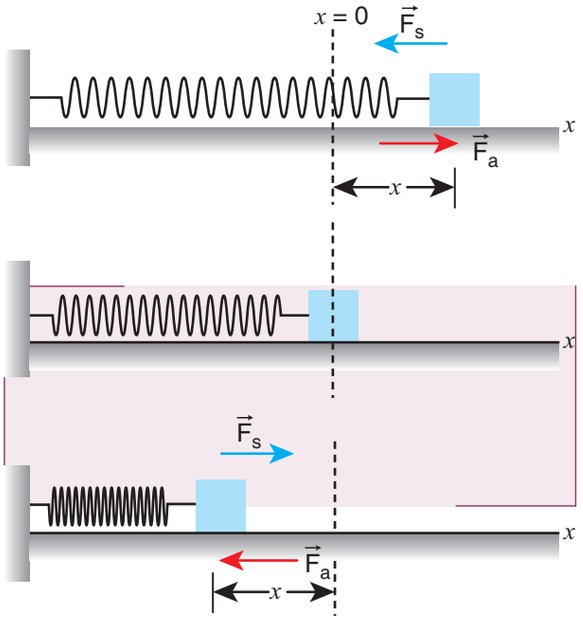


Figure 4.9 Potential energy of the spring (elastic potential energy)

As long as the spring remains in equilibrium position, its potential energy is zero. Now an external force $\vec{F}_a$ is applied so that it is stretched by a distance (x) in the direction of the force.

There is a restoring force called spring force $\vec{F}_s$ developed in the spring which tries to bring the mass back to its original position. This applied force and the spring force are equal in magnitude but opposite in direction i.e., $\vec{F}_a = -\vec{F}_s$. According Hooke's law, the restoring force developed in the spring is

$$\vec{F}_s = -k\vec{x} \qquad (4.20)$$

The negative sign in the above expression implies that the spring force is always opposite to that of displacement $\vec{x}$ and k

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